

The European Parliament Members of the Union for Europe of the Nations Group

- united by the values that derive from the respect for the individual which form the basis of European civilisation†and determined to defend the principles of liberty, solidarity and equality between individuals†
- convinced that the European Union can only be built and prosper if tradition, sovereignty, democracy and the identity of European peoples are respected;
- convinced that the European Union must develop as a force that creates stability in the world and that encourages dialogue between peoples†

are united in favour of

- a) a European Union founded on the right of peoples to express themselves by democratic means, and where the different cultures, identities and languages are respected and protected;
- b) a Europe that promotes solidarity between individuals and communities, between public institutions and civic society in order to bring about equality between the peoples of Europe;
- c) a Europe which seeks to protect the legitimate interests of all the people, which protects the less well-off, the elderly and the young, which promotes equal opportunities and education, which considers the family as the basic unit of our society, which recognise the sanctity of life and which is opposed to an exclusively materialistic concept of society;
- d) a Europe which defends the quality of life and which protects the environment and the updating of the rules governing animal health and welfare in order to reflect new scientific developments; which seeks to overcome the problems of overcrowding and urban decline in our cities and promoting the development of suburban, mountainous and island regions and which safeguards rural communities and defends the traditional rural way of life in order to protect the quality and diversity of traditional produce from different countries and regions;
- e) a Europe capable of driving forward the single market thereby creating advantages both for individual citizens and for the entire community, and of increasing the capacity of the EU to attract foreign investment by improving its own competitiveness and by encouraging economic and fiscal policies that can generate new investments and create new job opportunities;
- f) a Europe which pays particular attention to small and medium sized enterprises, and to the crafts sector, which seeks to improve the welfare of all and promotes respect for the dignity of workers;
- g) a Europe against all forms of racism and discrimination, which protects human rights and the dignity of life on its territory and throughout the world
- h) a Europe which co-operates effectively to combat international terrorism, organised crime, illegal immigration, trafficking in human beings, pedophilia, sexual abuse and sexual mutilation;
- i) a Europe where the Member States decide themselves on their priorities in foreign and defence policy, while wherever possible developing a common foreign and security policy, where appropriate in co-operation with the United Nations, N.A.T.O., the OSCE and other multilateral bodies;
- j) a European Union which seeks to strengthen relations with the United States in order to work closely together in tackling shared international problems;
- k) a European Union which encourages the emergence of democracy in all nations and is open to co-operation with democratic nations;
- l) a Europe which is generous towards less developed nations in particular in Africa, the ACP countries and in Latin America and which seeks to develop closer cooperation with those countries that have been the traditional recipients of immigration from European countries.